

r/artificial

AI has used a total of 670 billion litres of water

Posted by u/bankabletoast23 • 0 points • 34 comments

That's more water than the entire Sydney Harbour. Are there alternatives?

Comments

u/realcleverscience • 1 points • 2026-02-24 00:56 UTC

essential reading: <https://andymasley.substack.com/p/the-ai-water-issue-is-fake>

u/costafilho • 1 points • 2026-02-23 22:56 UTC

Not more than *GOLF*

u/recallingmemories • 1 points • 2026-02-23 22:48 UTC

Wait until you hear about alfalfa

u/bgrfrtwnr • 1 points • 2026-02-23 22:46 UTC

I would be very interested in the source of this statistic and how it was calculated before I take the bait of an anti-AI "discussion".

u/Theseus_Employee • 1 points • 2026-02-23 22:44 UTC

Just an important note, the word "used" here has a different connotation than it would if it "used gas/petrol".

Gas is no longer gas after it's used. But water is still water.

u/untilzero • 1 points • 2026-02-23 22:42 UTC

Shutting it off

u/jcrestor • 6 points • 2026-02-23 22:39 UTC

Define used.

The water is not gone, it has either been put back into the system deliberately or it has evaporated into the atmosphere and come down as rain or other kinds of humidity.

Of course I support regulation to build sustainable data centers, but the water talking point has barely any substance to it, especially if put into context of other water usage like in agriculture.

u/acutelychronicpanic • 3 points • 2026-02-23 22:37 UTC

A single apple takes over 25 gallons of water to grow.

And water isn't lost permanently. This is only a problem in water scarce regions, and even then, other industrial/agricultural use dominates.